

PLAYBOOK

GHL Automations Playbook

The standard workflows every client gets, and how to
build and test each one

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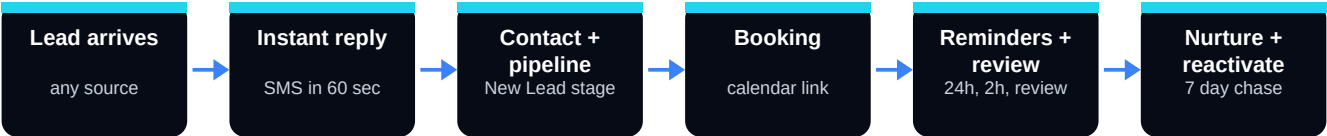


WHAT THIS IS

Once a sub-account passes the EW-TECH-04 baseline, these are the workflows you build, in this order, with this copy, tested this way. Use it for every client build and for every "the automation is not working" ticket. It produces seven published, tested workflows that catch every lead, book it, remind it, ask for the review, and chase it when it goes quiet.

DONE MEANS
Every standard workflow is Published, has a real test run in its enrollment history, uses the approved copy with the client's name, respects quiet hours, and is recorded in the client state file. Brad has done go live QC.

01 The automation map



Every lead, from every source, rides this rail. Each box is one or two workflows below.

Brad	Builder (you)	Client
Approves the copy changes, does go live QC, holds A2P and Stripe. Only Brad marks a workflow task done.	Builds, publishes and tests every workflow with a test contact. Records each one in the state file the same day.	Approves the message tone, supplies the Google review link, answers the internal notifications, tells us about no shows.

Workflow	Job it does	Build order
WF: Missed Call Text Back	Missed call gets a text in seconds	1
WF: Speed to Lead	New lead from any source gets SMS + email + owner alert + pipeline entry	2
WF: Appointment Confirm + Remind	Confirmation, 24h and 2h reminders, reschedule link, no show follow up	3
WF: Review Request	Ask for the Google review after a completed appointment, one ask, one nudge	4
WF: Lead Nurture 7 Day	Chases a lead that did not reply, then tags no - response	5
WF: Pipeline Stages	Moves the opportunity when booked, quoted, won	6
WF: Database Reactivation	Wakes up the dormant list, throttled, opt out safe	7, after domain warm up

02 Workflow builder fundamentals

Workflows are the only builder we use. Campaigns are the legacy tool; never build in them. A workflow is a trigger, a chain of actions, and a settings panel that decides how contacts enter and exit.

Piece	What it is	Our default
Trigger	The event that enrolls a contact (form submitted, call status, appointment status, tag added, stage changed)	One trigger per workflow unless the sources are truly the same event
Trigger filters	Conditions on the trigger (which form, which calendar, which pipeline)	Always filter; an unfiltered trigger fires on everything

Piece	What it is	Our default
Actions	Send SMS, Send Email, Internal Notification, Create/Update Opportunity, Add/Remove Tag, Update Contact Field, Add Task, Webhook	Keep it to what the section below lists
If / Else	Branch on a contact value, tag, reply, or appointment status	Name each branch in plain words
Wait	Delay for a set time, until an event, or until a contact replies	Use "wait for reply" before every follow up text
Allow Re-entry	Whether a contact can enroll again while or after being in the workflow	OFF, except reminders and review (see each)
Stop on response	Pull the contact out when they reply	ON for every nurture and follow up
Time window	Only run send actions inside set hours	08:00 to 21:00 client local, every day
Draft vs Published	Draft never fires, even if the trigger happens	Publish only after the test run passes
Enrollment history	The per contact log of every step and its result	First place you look on any ticket

1

Create the workflow

Automation, Workflows, Create Workflow, start from scratch. Name it "WF: purpose" exactly as listed in this document so every client sorts the same way.

2

Set the settings panel first

Open the gear or settings tab: Allow Re-entry off, Stop on response on, time window 08:00 to 21:00 in the client's time zone. Do this before adding steps so you do not forget.

3

Add the trigger and its filters

Pick the trigger, add the filter (which form, which calendar, which pipeline). Save the trigger.

4

Add actions in order

Build the chain. Use the client's custom values in copy, never hard typed names, so the same workflow copies cleanly to the next client.

5

Create a test contact

A contact named "Test Easyworks" with your own mobile and email. Tag it test. Every test uses this contact, never a real lead.

6

Test, then publish

Use the builder's test option or fire the real trigger with the test contact (submit the form, call the number, book the calendar).

Open the contact, check the enrollment history: every step shows executed, the SMS and email arrived on your phone.

Only now set the toggle to Published. Screenshot the history for the task notes.

7

Record it

Add the workflow name, trigger, and published date to the client state file the same day.

KNOWN BUILDER BUG

The GHL builder has shown a bug where an "AI Builder Enabled" modal re-opens and blocks editing. If it happens, reload, try the classic builder view, and if it still blocks, report it to Brad with a screenshot rather than fighting it for an hour.

CONFIRM WITH BRAD

The exact labels for the settings panel (Allow Re-entry, Stop on response, Time Window) shift between GHL releases. If you cannot find one, ask before assuming it does not exist.

03 Message copy rules

Rule	What it means in practice
Short	SMS under 160 characters. Email under 120 words. One idea per message.
Human	Sounds like the owner texting from their phone. No "Hi there!", no "I hope this finds you well", no dashes, no emoji.
First name	Open with <code>{{contact.first_name}}</code> . If the name is blank the fallback is "Hi", set it in the merge field.
One next step	Reply YES, or tap the booking link. Never both in the same message.
Business name	Every SMS carries <code>{{custom_values.company_name}}</code> so the reader knows who it is, and carriers see a compliant sender.
Opt out line	First SMS in any sequence, and every reactivation SMS, ends with "Reply STOP to opt out.". GHL handles STOP by marking DND; never text a DND contact.
Result, not tool	Say booked jobs, fewer missed calls, faster replies. Never say AI, bot, automation, or CRM to a customer.
Client voice	The client approves the seven message sets once at go live. After that, changes go through Brad.

QUIET HOURS

Nothing initiates contact between 21:00 and 08:00 client local. Every workflow gets the time window set, and every sequence uses a wait that holds until business hours. The one exception is a direct reply to a customer who just messaged us; that is a reply, not an initiation. Never clear a backlog at 08:01 in one burst; stagger it.

04 The standard workflows

WF: Missed Call Text Back

Purpose	The caller who got voicemail gets a text within seconds, so they do not dial the next business on Google.
Trigger	Call Status. Filters: direction incoming, status missed (also add voicemail, busy and no answer if offered), the client's number.
Actions	1. Send SMS. 2. Add tag new-lead if the contact is new. 3. Internal notification to the owner: "Missed call from <code>{{contact.phone}}</code> , text back sent". 4. Create opportunity in New Lead if none open.
Copy	"Hi <code>{{contact.first_name}}</code> , this is <code>{{custom_values.company_name}}</code> . Sorry we missed your call. How can we help? Reply here or book a time: <code>{{custom_values.booking_link}}</code> . Reply STOP to opt out."
Settings	Allow Re-entry ON with a 1 hour re-entry gap if the option exists, otherwise off (a repeat caller in 5 minutes should not get two texts). Time window on. Stop on response on.
Test	Call the client number from your phone, let it ring out. Text arrives within 30 seconds. Enrollment history shows all steps. Owner got the notification.
Common failure	Workflow left in draft; wrong number in the filter; A2P campaign not yet approved so the text is silently filtered. GHL also has a built in missed call text back toggle under the phone number's advanced settings; use one or the other, never both, or the caller gets two texts.

WF: Speed to Lead

Purpose	Every new lead from any source hears back inside 60 seconds and lands in the pipeline.
Trigger	Three triggers on one workflow, each filtered: Form Submitted (the site form), Facebook Lead Form Submitted (the mapped form), and the chat widget or Conversation AI new inbound where available.
Actions	1. Send SMS (below). 2. Send Email (short, same message, booking link as a button). 3. Internal notification to the owner by SMS and email: name, phone, source, what they asked for. 4. Create opportunity in "<Client> Sales Pipeline", stage New Lead, source from the trigger. 5. Add tag new-lead. 6. Update Lead Source field. 7. Wait 5 minutes for reply. 8. If no reply, add tag follow-up (which enrolls WF: Lead Nurture 7 Day).
Copy	"Hi {{contact.first_name}}, {{custom_values.company_name}} here, thanks for reaching out. What day works for a quick call, or grab a time here: {{custom_values.booking_link}}. Reply STOP to opt out."
Settings	Allow Re-entry off. Stop on response on. Time window on: a 23:30 form fill gets its SMS at 08:00, but the internal notification is not in the time window so the owner still sees it at night.
Test	Submit the site form with the test contact. Phone buzzes inside 60 seconds, email arrives, owner alert arrives, opportunity appears in New Lead with the right source. Repeat once with a Facebook test lead.
Common failure	Facebook form not mapped so the trigger never fires; internal notification placed inside the time window so the owner sleeps through it; duplicate contacts because the form did not match on phone.

WF: Appointment Confirm + Remind

Purpose	Fewer no shows. Confirmation at booking, reminders at 24 hours and 2 hours, a reschedule link, and a follow up if they do not show.
Trigger	Appointment Status: booked or confirmed, filtered to the client's calendar. A second trigger, Appointment Status no show, feeds the no show branch.
Actions	1. Send SMS confirmation. 2. Send Email confirmation with address and what to bring. 3. Update opportunity to Booked / Site Visit. 4. Wait until 24 hours before the appointment, send reminder SMS. 5. Wait until 2 hours before, send reminder SMS. 6. On no show: wait 30 minutes, send the no show SMS, add task for the owner to call.
Copy	Confirm: "Hi {{contact.first_name}}, you are booked with {{custom_values.company_name}} on {{appointment.start_time}}. Need to change it? {{appointment.reschedule_link}}". 24h: "See you tomorrow at {{appointment.start_time}}, {{contact.first_name}}. Reply C to confirm." 2h: "Reminder: {{custom_values.company_name}} today at {{appointment.start_time}}." No show: "Sorry we missed you today, {{contact.first_name}}. Want to rebook? {{custom_values.booking_link}}"
Settings	Allow Re-entry ON (a contact books more than once). Stop on response off (a reply must not cancel the 2 hour reminder). Time window on, but the appointment event waits already land in business hours.
Test	Book the test contact for tomorrow inside business hours. Confirmation arrives at once, the 24h reminder can be checked by booking 25 hours out, the 2h by booking 2.5 hours out. Mark the test appointment no show and check the follow up.
Common failure	Reminder timed from the trigger instead of from the appointment time (use the appointment based wait); calendar not linked so the trigger never fires; time zone on the profile wrong so reminders land at 3 am.

WF: Review Request

Purpose	Turn every completed appointment into a Google review, without nagging.
Trigger	Appointment Status: showed or completed, on the client's calendar. For trades, the Job Status field changing to Completed.
Actions	1. Wait 2 hours (still same day, inside the time window). 2. Send review request SMS with the Google review link (the Reputation review link, or the client's direct link stored in a custom value Review Link). 3. Wait 3 days. 4. If no click and no review, send one nudge. 5. Add tag customer. 6. Stop.
Copy	Ask: "Thanks for choosing {{custom_values.company_name}}, {{contact.first_name}}. If we did a good job, a quick Google review helps a lot: {{custom_values.review_link}}". Nudge: "{{contact.first_name}}, one small favour. 30 seconds for a review? {{custom_values.review_link}} Thank you."
Settings	Allow Re-entry ON with a 90 day gap so a repeat customer is not asked every visit. Stop on response on. Time window on.
Test	Mark the test appointment as showed. Ask arrives after 2 hours. Move the wait to 2 minutes for the test, then set it back before publishing, and screenshot the final settings.
Common failure	Review link missing or pointing at the wrong listing; two asks because the trigger fires on both showed and completed; asking a customer who complained (add an If / Else on tag complaint to skip).

WF: Lead Nurture 7 Day

Purpose	A lead who did not reply to the first message gets chased for a week, then rests, so nothing is forgotten and nobody is spammed.
Trigger	Tag added: follow-up.
Actions	Day 1 (next business morning): SMS. Day 2: email. Day 4: SMS. Day 7: email, last one. Each send is followed by a wait for reply up to the next step. At the end: remove tag follow-up, add tag no-response, move opportunity stage to Lost only if Brad set that rule for the client, otherwise leave in Contacted.
Copy	Day 1: "Hi {{contact.first_name}}, {{custom_values.company_name}} again. Still want a hand with this? Reply YES and we will sort a time." Day 4: "{{contact.first_name}}, last check, happy to help whenever you are ready: {{custom_values.booking_link}}". Day 7 email: two lines, thank them, leave the booking link, say we will stop reaching out.
Settings	Allow Re-entry off. Stop on response on. Time window on. Goal: appointment booked exits the workflow.
Test	Add tag follow-up to the test contact. Shrink the waits to minutes for the test, confirm the four messages and the tags at the end, restore the real waits, publish.
Common failure	Re-entry left on and the contact loops; a reply pauses nothing because Stop on response is off; a booked lead keeps getting chased because there is no goal or exit on appointment booked.

WF: Pipeline Stages

Purpose	The opportunity moves itself. Nobody has to remember to drag a card.
Trigger	Three small workflows or one with branches: Appointment booked moves to Booked / Site Visit; custom field Quote Sent filled moves to Quote Sent and adds tag quote-sent; opportunity status Won adds tag customer and sends the owner a note (repeat Won adds repeat-customer).
Actions	Update Opportunity (stage and status), Add Tag, Internal Notification. On Won: also remove follow-up and new-lead so no chase fires at a customer.

Settings	Allow Re-entry ON (a contact can move many times). No time window needed (no customer facing sends).
Test	Book the test contact: card moves. Fill Quote Sent on the test contact: card moves and the tag shows. Mark Won: tag customer shows, follow-up gone.
Common failure	Trigger points at the default Marketing Pipeline instead of the client pipeline; Update Opportunity creates a second card because "update existing" was not selected.

WF: Database Reactivation

Purpose	Message the dormant list (customers with no job in 6 months or more) with one clear offer and get bookings from contacts the client already owns.
Segment	Smart list: tag customer, no appointment in 180 days, not DND, has a valid mobile. Never include no-response, fu-dead, or anyone who complained. Export the count and get Brad and the client to approve the segment and the offer before enrolling.
Trigger	Manual: add the segment to the workflow in batches. Never a contact created trigger.
Actions	1. Send SMS. 2. Wait 3 days for reply. 3. One follow up SMS. 4. Wait 4 days. 5. Remove tag reactivation, add tag reactivation-done. Replies go to the owner or Conversation AI to book.
Copy	"Hi {{contact.first_name}}, it is {{custom_values.company_name}}. It has been a while. This month we are offering <offer the client approved>. Want a spot? Reply YES. Reply STOP to opt out."
Throttle	Batches of 50 to 100 a day, spread across the morning, using the batch or drip option when adding contacts. Never a blast, never before the sending domain is warmed and the A2P campaign approved.
Settings	Allow Re-entry off. Stop on response on. Time window on. STOP replies mark DND automatically; check the DND count the next day and report it to Brad.
Test	Enroll the test contact only. Check the copy, the opt out handling (reply STOP from your phone, confirm DND shows), and that the follow up waits. Then and only then enroll the first batch.
Common failure	Segment includes people who said no before; sent from a cold domain and lands in spam; too many at once and the carrier flags the number; no offer, just "checking in", so nobody replies.

05 Cold call follow up tag set

For clients whose team makes outbound calls (and for the Easyworks sales team), one tag at the end of each call runs the follow up. Each tag is the trigger of its own workflow, built with the same rules as section 04. The rule for the caller: tag every call, no exceptions, or nothing fires.

Tag	Apply when	What the workflow does
fu-vm	Voicemail or no answer	5 touches over 14 days, SMS and email mix, booking link as the CTA
fu-warm	They talked, were open, want info	4 touches over 7 days aimed at booking a short call
fu-callback	They asked for a call on a set day	1 confirmation SMS plus a task for the rep at the callback time
fu-soft-no	Polite no, maybe later	1 thank you email, then a check in at 90 and 180 days
fu-booked	Booked on the spot	Confirmation, 24h and 1h reminders, a recap email the rep fills in after
fu-dead	Hard no, wrong fit, asked to be removed	Nothing sends. Contact marked DND and closed

Exit conditions on every fu - * workflow: any reply, an appointment booked, or a different fu - * tag applied. Applying a new tag must remove the old one and remove the contact from the old workflow. The sender name in the copy is the current rep, set as a custom value, never hard typed.

06 Triggers to actions, quick reference

When this happens (trigger)	Filter on	Do this (actions)
Form Submitted	Which form	SMS, email, owner alert, create opportunity, tag
Facebook Lead Form Submitted	Which form or page	Same as form, Lead Source = Social
Call Status	Incoming, missed or voicemail, which number	SMS text back, owner alert
Customer Replied	Channel, keyword	Remove from nurture, notify owner, branch on YES
Appointment Status	Which calendar, which status	Confirm, remind, no show follow up, review ask, stage move
Contact Tag added	Which tag	Enroll in nurture or the fu - * sequence
Contact Field changed	Quote Sent, Job Status	Stage move, tag, review ask (Completed)
Opportunity Status or Stage changed	Which pipeline, which stage	Tag customer, notify, remove chase tags
Trigger Link Clicked	Which link	Tag clicked, stop the nudge
Stale Opportunity	Days in stage	Task for owner, nudge SMS
Inbound Webhook	Source system	Create or update contact, then the Speed to Lead actions

07 Troubleshooting: the twelve usual suspects

These come from the questions we ask every builder we vet. If a client says "the automation is not working", walk this table top to bottom before you change anything.

Check	How to check	Fix
Not Published	Workflow list shows Draft	Publish after a test run
Trigger never fired	Contact, workflow enrollment history is empty	Wrong trigger or wrong filter (form, calendar, pipeline); fix the filter
Filter excluded the contact	History shows enrolled then skipped, or the contact misses a field	Loosen the filter or fix the data (phone format, tag spelling)
Re-entry loops or duplicate texts	Same contact enrolled several times	Allow Re-entry off, or set the re-entry gap
Contact is DND	Contact card shows DND on SMS	They replied STOP; do not override. Tell the client
A2P not approved	Phone Numbers, campaign status pending or rejected	Wait or resubmit; no texts until Approved (see EW-TECH-04)
Time window held it	History shows waiting	Expected overnight; confirm it sends at 08:00
Calendar not linked	Appointment trigger silent; slots wrong	Google calendar linked to the right user, conflict check on, hours and buffers (EW-TECH-04 stage 4)
Email in spam	Test headers show SPF or DKIM fail	Verify the sending domain; slow the warm up

Check	How to check	Fix
Tags vs fields mixed up	Trigger on a field that is really a tag, or data stored in tags	Tags label and trigger; fields store data
Built in Campaigns	Sequence lives under the legacy Campaigns menu	Rebuild as a workflow
Snapshot loaded stale copy	Workflow references a different client's values	Use custom values, not typed names; re-check every workflow after a snapshot load

SNAPSHOTS

Snapshots are how we go fast: a saved copy of a finished sub-account (workflows, pipeline, calendars, values) loaded into the next client. Every workflow in this document is written with custom values so it survives a snapshot. After loading one, still run every test in section 04; a snapshot is a head start, not a finished build.

CONFIRM WITH BRAD

Whether a standard Easyworks snapshot exists yet for these seven workflows, and its name in the agency.

08 Definition of done and when it goes wrong

Definition of done

☐	All seven standard workflows exist, named "WF: purpose" exactly as listed, and are Published
☐	Every workflow has Allow Re-entry, Stop on response and the 08:00 to 21:00 time window set as specified
☐	Every customer facing message uses the approved copy, the client's custom values, first name, one next step, and the opt out line where required
☐	Each workflow has a real test run with the Test Easyworks contact visible in enrollment history, screenshot in the task notes
☐	Speed to Lead measured: SMS arrived within 60 seconds of a form submit, owner alert arrived
☐	Missed call text back tested by a real missed call; only one text arrived
☐	Reminders tested against a real appointment time, not the trigger time; no show branch tested
☐	Review link confirmed to open the client's own Google listing
☐	Reactivation segment and offer approved by Brad and the client; batch size and throttle set; STOP tested
☐	Test contact and test opportunities deleted; no test tagged contacts left
☐	Client state file lists every workflow, trigger and publish date, updated today
☐	Task moved to review; Brad completed go live QC as the client would use it

When it goes wrong

Symptom	First three checks	Who to tell
"The automation is not working"	1. Published, not draft. 2. Enrollment history on the contact. 3. Trigger filter matches the contact	Brad if it was working and stopped
Lead got the same text twice	1. Allow Re-entry. 2. Two workflows on the same trigger (built in text back plus WF). 3. Duplicate contact	Brad, same day, and apologise to the client
No text arrived at all	1. A2P status. 2. Contact DND. 3. Time window holding it	Brad if A2P is rejected
Reminder sent at 3 am	1. Profile time zone. 2. Time window on the workflow. 3. Wait based on appointment time, not trigger	Brad, plus the client gets a heads up

Symptom	First three checks	Who to tell
Owner alert never arrives	1. Owner number and email in the internal notification. 2. Notification placed inside the time window. 3. Owner's phone blocked the number	Client to whitelist, Brad if config
Opportunity not created or duplicated	1. Pipeline and stage in the action. 2. Update existing selected. 3. Contact matched by phone	Brad if the pipeline is wrong
Review ask went to an unhappy customer	1. Add the complaint tag branch. 2. Check who tagged. 3. Pause the workflow	Brad and the client, immediately
Reactivation replies are all STOP	1. Segment quality. 2. Offer and copy. 3. Batch size	Stop the batch, tell Brad before the next one
Builder modal keeps re-opening	1. Reload. 2. Classic builder view. 3. Different browser	Brad with a screenshot